

Report for Arlington County Board

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October 7, 2026[§]

Abstract

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*Conflict of Interest: *[disclosure to come, Sally]*.

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[§]Notes and acknowledgments: *[to come]*.

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Executive Summary

In 2026 the Arlington County Board sought an independent, non-partisan examination of the structure and performance of the County's form of government. Its scope of work¹ asked for three things: a historical analysis of how Arlington's form of government developed and how that history bears on its performance and public participation today; a synthesis of the community feedback the Board has received on it and of how future engagement might proceed; and an outline of the concepts and questions the Board might take up in any future work on its structure and on public participation. The National Civic League leads the work, with Sally Hudson and Alex Keena.

This report answers the charge in three parts, one for each deliverable. Part A is the history of the Board: how it has been built, how its members have been elected, who has served on it, and what Virginia law has let the County decide for itself. Part B is what residents have said, in public comment, in letters to the Board and in the County's surveys. Part C sets out the questions the first two parts point toward.

1. Arlington County Board, *Board Structure and Performance Study, Scope of Work and Qualifications* (May 13, 2026).

Part A. Historical Background

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A.1 Board Structure

Board Duties

Alexandria County returned to Virginia in 1847, after Congress's act of 1846 and a vote of its residents, and a county court of elected justices of the peace governed it, levying the county's taxes as well as judging its cases.^{2,3} Until 1870 the county had no elected body whose only business was to govern it. The 1869 constitution created one in every county, a board of supervisors with one member from each township,⁴ and Arlington's first three were elected in May 1870.⁵

Three supervisors were the county's elected government until November 4, 1930, when voters adopted the County Manager Plan, 1,936 to 428.⁶ The Plan put a second office beside the Board. The Board appoints a County Manager, who holds the county's administrative and executive powers, including the appointment of officers and employees, and the Board may not move any budget allocation by more than 10 percent.⁷

The act left one question open, and it was the one that mattered: who appoints the department heads. The Board had made those appointments until 1937, when it delegated the power to the Manager. In January 1951 it took the power back by resolution, and in March 1951 a circuit judge ruled that it had no right to give the power up.⁸ The next spring the General Assembly barred a Board member from directing or requesting an appointment below the Board, on pain of losing his seat,⁹ and in November 1952 voters settled the matter, the last time they amended the plan, by approving both questions the General Assembly put to them: that the Manager serve an indefinite term, removable at any time by the Board, and that the Manager appoint department heads.¹⁰ From then on the Board hired and could dismiss one executive and could not reach past him to the staff.

The County's own rules have since applied that division to particular jobs. Under the County Code the Manager appoints and removes employees in the competitive service and the executive management service and writes the personnel regulations, while the Board approves the pay and classi-

2. Act of July 9, 1846, ch. 35, 9 Stat. 35.

3. Code of Virginia of 1860, ch. 53, secs. 1 and 3.

4. Va. Const. of 1869, art. VII, sec. 2.

5. Acts of the General Assembly, Session of 1869–70, chs. 39, 76 and 188.

6. Cornelia B. Rose Jr., *Arlington County, Virginia: A History* (Arlington: Arlington Historical Society, 1976), 194–196.

7. Act of Mar. 20, 1930, ch. 167, 1930 Va. Acts 450.

8. "Spicer Suggests, in New Book, Changes in Arlington County Governmental Relationships," *Daily Sun* (Arlington, Va.), December 17, 1951, 5; "Board Wins Ruling Affirming Power to Appoint Heads of Departments," *Sun* (Arlington, Va.), March 23, 1951, 1.

9. Act of Apr. 1, 1952, ch. 443, 1952 Va. Acts 732.

10. Act of Mar. 6, 1952, ch. 198, 1952 Va. Acts 226; "City Charter for Arlington Soundly Beaten," *Daily Sun* (Arlington, Va.), November 5, 1952, 1.

fication plans and may not set the pay of any one competitive employee.¹¹ The Board appropriates money by department, and the Manager may move funds within a department.¹² A capital construction contract above \$1,000,000 needs the Board's approval,¹³ and even the Board's agenda passes through the Manager, who drafts the list of proposed items about two weeks before each regular meeting for the Chair to approve.¹⁴ The Board, in short, sets the budget, the pay plan and the large contracts, and the Manager runs the staff beneath them.

The Board keeps a few officers of its own. A 1968 statute let any county create the office of county attorney, serving at the governing body's pleasure.¹⁵ The General Assembly has since let a board under the plan appoint its own county auditor, in 2015, and an independent policing auditor, in 2026, each serving at the board's pleasure.¹⁶ Arlington's Board hires its policing auditor under an ordinance effective July 1, 2026.¹⁷ Where the state's law, not the County's, limits what the Board may do, as in *County Board of Arlington v. Brown* (1985), Section A.4 takes it up.

Board Seats

For its first 60 years Arlington was a small county that grew slowly, from about 3,000 residents in 1870 to 27,000 in 1930. Then federal employment arrived, first under the New Deal and then with the militarization of the 1940s, and the county reached 57,000 residents in 1940 and 135,000 in 1950, five times its size 20 years earlier.¹⁸ It has not stopped: the 2020 census counted 239,000.

The Board has changed size once. For those first 60 years it was three supervisors, one each from the Arlington, Jefferson and Washington districts (Figure 2), and the referendum of November 4, 1930, that adopted the Plan also replaced them with five members elected at large (Section A.2); the first such Board took its seats in January 1932. With the population of 1930, the change cut the residents each seat stood for from about 9,000 to about 5,000. The county then outgrew it within a decade, to 11,000 residents a seat in 1940 and 27,000 in 1950, and each seat stands for about 48,000 today, against about 1,000 in 1870.

The General Assembly did offer a way to grow the Board. In 1952 it let Arlington voters put a seven-member Board on the ballot by a petition of 200 voters filed by August 1, and nobody filed one.¹⁹ It reopened the window in 1954 and 1958, for the question of election every two years only, and again nobody petitioned.²⁰ Part C sets Arlington's residents per member beside those of Virginia's other large localities (Figure 11).

11. Arlington County, *Arlington County, Chapter 6: Civil Service*, Chapter 6 of the Arlington County Code, 27 pages. (2026).

12. Arlington County, *FY 2027 Adopted Budget, County Budget and Appropriations Resolutions* (April 22, 2026).

13. Arlington County, *Purchasing Resolution, July 2025* (July 2025).

14. Arlington County, "2026 County Board Meeting Procedures (Excerpt)," Arlington County Board, 2026.

15. Act of Apr. 5, 1968, ch. 695, 1968 Va. Acts 1239.

16. Commonwealth of Virginia, "Code of Virginia § 15.2-709.2, County Auditor," 2015; Acts of Assembly, 2026 session, chapter 372 (HB 226), Independent Policing Auditor (Apr. 8, 2026).

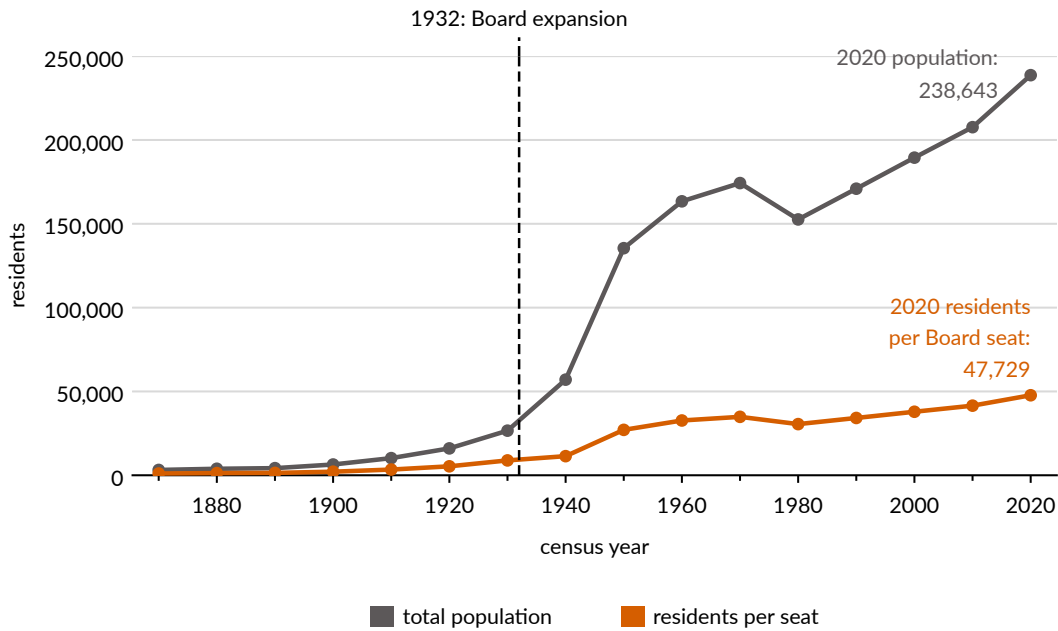
17. Arlington County, *Arlington County, Chapter 69 - Law Enforcement Community Oversight Board and Independent Policing Auditor* (July 2026).

18. Lindsey Bestebreurtje, "Built by the People Themselves: African American Community Development in Arlington, Virginia, from the Civil War through Civil Rights" (PhD dissertation, George Mason University, 2017), 239–40, 248.

19. Act of Apr. 3, 1952, ch. 591, 1952 Va. Acts 1035.

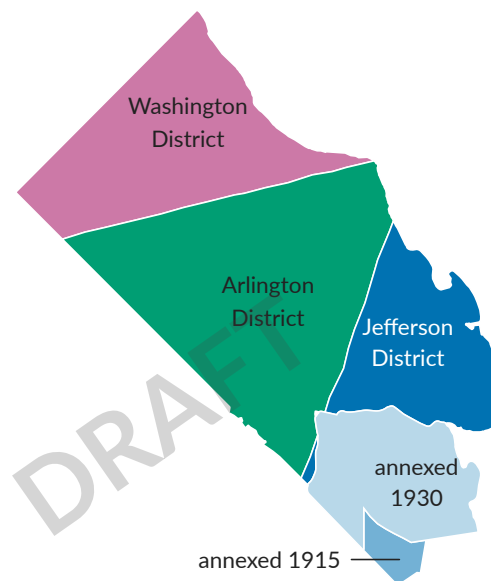
20. Act of Mar. 5, 1954, ch. 151, 1954 Va. Acts 148; Act of Mar. 6, 1958, ch. 207, 1958 Va. Acts 263.

FIGURE 1
County Population and Board Size



Source: US decennial census, 1870–2020.

FIGURE 2
The Three Magisterial Districts, 1870–1931



Notes: The county as it stood before Alexandria annexed land from it in 1915 and 1930, with the three districts as they stood from 1870 until the Board went at-large in 1932. The 1907 county map is the only map found that draws the district lines, and the lines here are read from it to within a few hundred meters. The paler areas are the land Alexandria annexed in 1915 and 1930, almost all of it Jefferson district. The city as it stood in 1912 is left blank. The Potomac is the right-hand edge. Source: Noetzel and Boteler, Map of Alexandria County (1907); Rose (1964); Census Bureau and Arlington County boundary files.

A.2 Election Method

Arlington has elected its Board three ways since 1870, and what separates them is how many seats one ballot fills and who counts as the electorate for each.

Districts, At-Large Election and Ranked Choice

Under single-winner districts the county is divided into areas and each elects one member, so a voter has one vote in one seat. A district favors a minority concentrated in one neighborhood: the Supreme Court asks whether such a group is large and geographically compact enough to make a majority in a single-member district, and where its members are scattered they cannot.²¹

Election at large puts every seat to every voter in the county. When one seat is open on the ballot, a voter has one vote, as in a district, but the electorate is the whole county, so a group must carry the county and its concentration in one neighborhood no longer counts. When several seats are open on one ballot, the method is block voting: every voter votes for as many candidates as there are seats, and the candidates with the most votes win.²² A block vote favors the largest group. If the voters in the biggest bloc support the same candidates, that bloc picks every winner and the rest of the community picks none. In Lynchburg in 2022 three Republican nominees took all three at-large council seats, with 12,287, 11,658 and 10,685 votes, while the leading independent finished 528 votes behind the third of them.^{23,24} That is what makes a block vote hyper-majoritarian: the rule lets a bare majority voting as one take every seat on the ballot and leaves a smaller bloc none.

In the account of a 1979 University of Virginia study, block voting spread because the reformers who adopted it saw it as a weapon: in many cities in the early 1900s, “upper-class, business-led reformers regarded at-large elections as a device to reduce the influence of working class and ethnic neighborhoods that found expression through ward based elections.”²⁵ A study of 1976 council seats found what the device could do: Black residents of cities electing at large held about half the representation their share of the population would warrant, slightly less than half of what Black residents of ward cities held.²⁶

Under ranked choice voting, which the General Assembly calls instant runoff voting, a voter ranks candidates in order of preference and the count proceeds in rounds, either electing a candidate or defeating the last-place candidate and passing those votes to the voters’ next choices, until the seats are filled.²⁷ In a single-winner count, a candidate needs more than half the votes, and the candidate with the fewest is eliminated round by round until one passes half.²⁸ In a multi-winner count, the single transferable vote, a candidate needs a smaller share set by the number of seats, and a winner’s surplus passes to the voters’ next choices.²⁹ Arlington used the multi-winner count once, in the Democratic primary of 2023.

21. *Thornburg v. Gingles*, 478 U.S. 30, 50 (Supreme Court of the United States 1986).

22. Arlington County Board Office, *Ranked Choice Voting for Upcoming General Elections* (Arlington County, Virginia, March 11, 2026).

23. Virginia Department of Elections, “Historical Elections Database,” contest 156756.

24. *Thornburg v. Gingles*, 478 U.S. at 48–49.

25. Timothy G. O'Rourke, *City and County At-Large Elections and the Problem of Minority Representation*, University of Virginia Newsletter 55, no. 6 (Institute of Government, University of Virginia, February 1979).

26. Berry, Barbara L. and Dye, Thomas R., “The Discriminatory Effects of At-Large Elections,” *Florida State University Law Review*, 1979, 122.

27. Act of Apr. 6, 2020, ch. 713, 2020 Va. Acts.

28. Arlington County Board Office, *Ranked Choice Voting for Upcoming General Elections*.

29. Act of Apr. 6, 2020.

Districts, 1870–1930

For its first 60 years the Board was chosen district by district. Arlington, Jefferson and Washington each elected one supervisor, so a voter had one vote and a say in one seat of three. Through 1901 a supervisor served a single year, from July 1 after the May election, and his district's voters were back at the polls the next spring.^{30,31} The constitution of 1902 moved county elections to November and lengthened the term to four years beginning each January 1; the supervisors elected in May 1901 served 30 months, to January 1, 1904, and the first November winners took their seats then.³²

At Large, 1930 to the Present

In November 1930 the county's voters ended the district system. In the referendum that adopted the County Manager Plan they chose election at large over election by district, 1,689 to 1,149.³³ The county's case for one electorate ran through *Bennett v. Garrett* (1922), in which the Supreme Court of Appeals had refused Clarendon a town charter because the "general good of the community" the statute protects "must be construed as embracing the whole section";³⁴ Cornelia Rose's county history reads that reasoning into the at-large method the county chose in 1930.³⁵

The first at-large election, in November 1931, put 51 candidates before every voter for five seats, and the whole Board stood at once.³⁶ That was a block vote in full, and the Board stood together again every four years until 1938.

Staggered Terms, 1938 to the Present

In 1938 voters approved staggered terms, 1,539 to 1,487 in the county's tally.^{37,38} The ballot asked only whether members should be elected "as provided in Sec. 2773-F1 of the Code of Virginia," and the Commonwealth's Attorney's office fielded calls from voters asking what that meant. The Arlington County Woman's Democratic Club opposed the plan, warning that it would make it "virtually impossible for a woman to be elected to the board."³⁹

Staggering changed the ballot as much as the calendar. From the Board elected in 1939, one member was chosen in most years and two in the fourth, in 1943, 1947, 1951 and every fourth year after.⁴⁰ In a two-seat year a voter cast two votes, as the county's returns for 1955 head the County Board contest "Vote for 2," and the two candidates with the most votes won.⁴¹ That is block voting: each voter may support as many candidates as there are seats, and the highest totals win.

30. Va. Const. of 1869, art. VII, sec. 2.

31. Acts of the General Assembly, Session of 1869–70, ch. 76, secs. 4 and 14.

32. Va. Const. of 1902, sec. 112; Schedule, sec. 10.

33. Rose, *Arlington County, Virginia: A History*, 194–196.

34. *Bennett v. Garrett*, 132 Va. 397, 112 S.E. 772 (1922).

35. Rose, *Arlington County, Virginia: A History*, 176, 197.

36. Robert Nelson Anderson, "Arlington Adopts the County Manager Form of Government," *Arlington Historical Magazine*, 1958, 67.

37. Arlington County Office of Voter Registration and Elections, *Arlington County Election Results* (Arlington County, Virginia, November 18, 2021), 11.

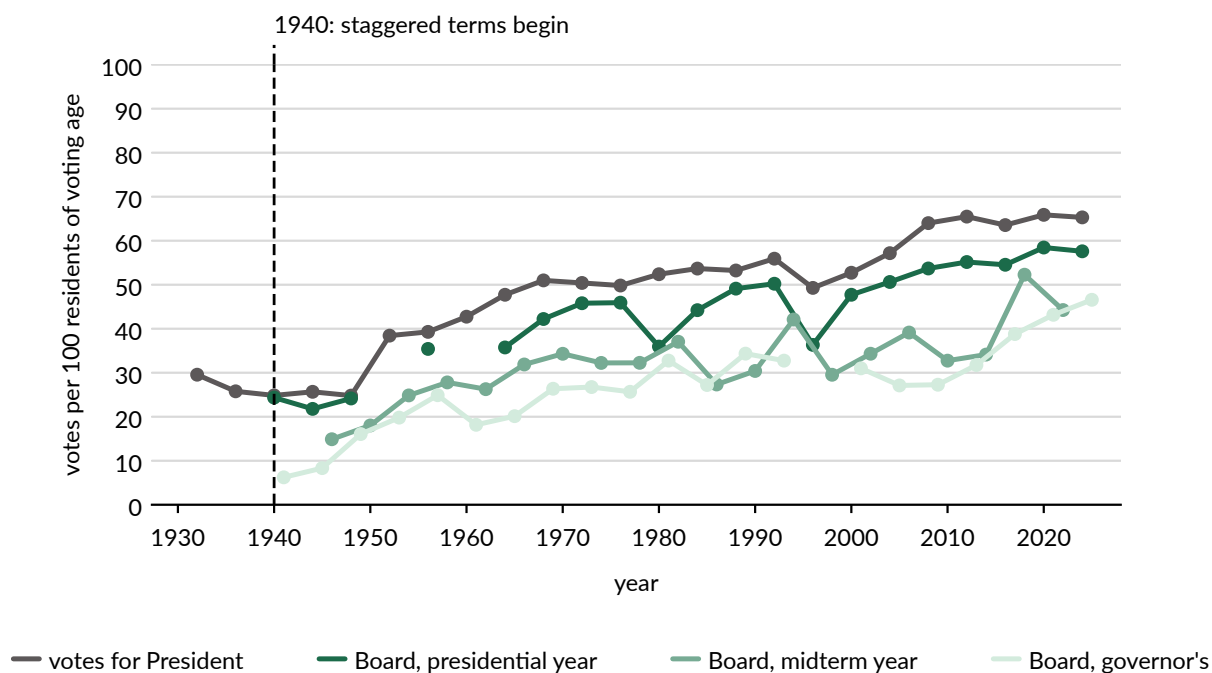
38. "Referendum Wins by 61 Votes; Board Will Be 'Staggered,'" *Sun* (Arlington, Va.), November 11, 1938, 1.

39. "Referendum Wins by 61 Votes; Board Will Be 'Staggered'."

40. Arlington Historical Society, "County Officials in Arlington, 1870–1960," *Arlington Historical Magazine*, October 1967, 37.

41. Arlington County Office of Voter Registration and Elections, *Arlington County Election Results*, 28.

FIGURE 3
Votes Cast per 100 Residents of Voting Age, 1932–2024



Notes: Residents of voting age are men aged 21 and over through 1916, all residents 21 and over from 1920, when women first vote, and all residents 18 and over from 1971. Each is the census count, with a straight line between censuses, and includes non-citizens and the people the laws of the day disfranchised. A dashed rule marks 1940, the first staggered election; before it the Board's five seats were filled all at once, in 1931, 1935 and 1939. From 1940 the Board's vote is drawn only for years that filled one seat, shaded by what led the ballot. A year that filled more than one seat, or whose count is incomplete, is left blank, because its votes are not its voters. Source: Warrock-Richardson Almanack; Secretary of the Commonwealth; Virginia Department of Elections; *Alexandria Gazette*; O'Leary (2010); Arlington County, *Arlington Elections*; US decennial census, 1870–2020.

In the other years no ballot was a sweep, because no ballot held more than one seat. Every one of those seats, though, went to the same countywide electorate, so a majority bloc that held together won each seat as it came up, and over one four-year cycle it held all five. Staggering made five seats look like five separate choices spread across four years. For a majority that votes as one they are a single choice made in installments, and its result is the one a block vote would have produced in 1931.

Though every seat went to the countywide electorate, no two went to the same voters. The seat was one race on a ballot headed by something else, a President, a governor or only Congress, and what headed the ballot decided how many people came out. In the presidential year 2012 the Board's vote equalled 55 percent of residents of voting age; in the governor's year after it, 32 percent (Figure 3). In each of the 19 presidential years from 1940 through 2024 that can be set beside the governor's year after it, the presidential year drew the larger vote. Two members of one Board, elected a year apart, were chosen by electorates of different size.

Ranked Choice, 2020 to the Present

The General Assembly authorized ranked choice voting in 2020, letting a county under the Manager Plan provide by ordinance for instant runoff voting in the nomination or election of its Board.⁴² A single-winner count still fills one seat from one countywide electorate, by a majority of the ballots that reach the final round. The County Board adopted ranked choice voting for all later primaries in December 2023, so the primaries of 2024 and 2025 each filled one nomination by a single-winner count, and in February 2025 it extended the method to the November 2025 general election, a contest for one seat.⁴³

The multi-winner count of 2023 is the exception. With two nominations open among six candidates in the state-run Democratic primary, the count was a two-winner single transferable vote: a nominee's surplus passed to the voters' next choices. Natalie Roy had more first choices than Maureen Coffey, 5,607 to 5,421, and Coffey was nominated beside Susan Cunningham all the same.^{44,45} Roy led on first choices and Coffey was nominated on transfers.

42. Act of Apr. 6, 2020.

43. Arlington County Board Office, *Ranked Choice Voting for Upcoming General Elections*.

44. Virginia Department of Elections, "Historical Elections Database," contest 160326.

45. "UPDATED: Coffey, Cunningham Win County Board Primary," ARLnow, June 23, 2023.

A.3 Demographic Representation

In September 2019 the Arlington County Board adopted an equity resolution committing the County to collect and disaggregate data on disparities and to ask of its decisions who benefits, who is burdened and who is missing.⁴⁶ This report turns that last question on the Board itself. It reads the Board's history through the resolution, asking who has held the Board's seats and who has not: how many seats there were, who sat in them, and how that has changed for women, for residents of color and for the young.

Of the 126 people who have served on the Board since 1870, 102 have been white men. Table 1 lists the other 24, in the order they first took a seat: 13 women and 12 members of color, Tannia Talento among both.

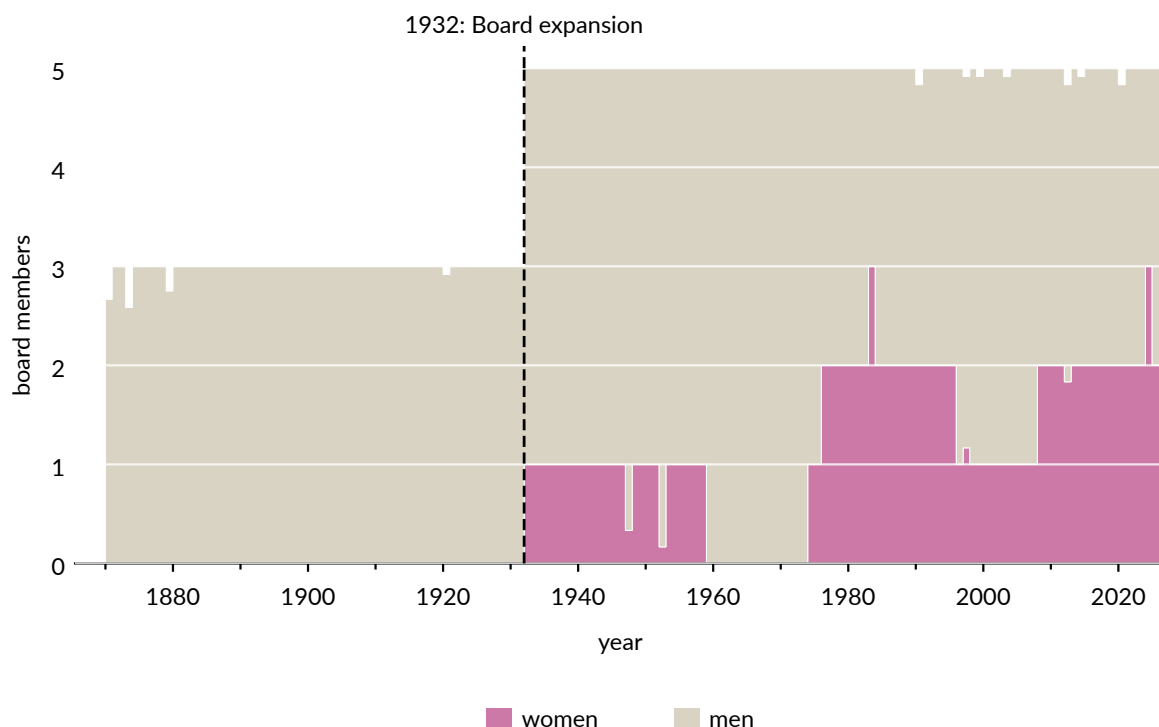
46. Arlington County Board, *Equity Resolution* (September 21, 2019).

TABLE 1
Women and Members of Color on the Board

Name	Served	Seated By	Born	Gender	Race and Ethnicity
1800s					
William A. Rowe	1871–1883	election	1834 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
John B. Syphax	1872	election	1839 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
Travis B. Pinn	1879–1881	election	1841 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
John W. Pendleton	1883–1884	election	1848 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
Tibbett Allen	1887–1888	election	1840 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
Walter G. Willson	1889–1892	election	—	man ^a	Black ^p
1900s					
Elizabeth B. Magruder	1932–1947	election	1878 ^c	woman ^{c,p}	White ^c
Florence Cannon	1948–1951	election	1889 ^c	woman ^{c,p}	White ^c
Leone B. Buchholz	1952–1958	special election	1899 ^c	woman ^{c,p}	White ^c
Ellen Bozman	1974–1997	election	1925 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Dorothy Grotos	1976–1983	election	1931 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Mary Margaret Whipple	1983–1995	election	1941 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
William T. Newman, Jr.	1988–1993	election	1950 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p
Barbara A. Favola	1997–2011	special election	1955 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
2000s					
Charles P. Monroe	2000–2003	election	1957 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p
J. Walter Tejada	2003–2015	special election	1958 ^p	man ^p	Hispanic ^p
Mary H. Hynes	2008–2015	election	1956 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Libby T. Garvey	2012–2024	special election	1951 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Christian E. Dorsey	2016–2023	election	1972 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p
Kate A. "Katie" Cristol	2016–2023	election	1985 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Tannia Talento	2023	appointment	—	woman ^p	Hispanic ^p
Maureen E. Coffey	2024–	election	1995 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Susan R. Cunningham	2024–	election	—	woman ^p	White ^a
Julius D. "JD" Spain, Sr.	2025–	election	1972 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p

Notes: Superscripts indicate the source for each record: the US census (c), press or published profile (p), or assumption (a). Two superscripts mean two kinds of source agree. A dash means no source gives the value. This table is a subset of the full roster, Table 2 in the Data Appendix.

FIGURE 4
Board Members by Gender



Notes: Census records identify gender for 63 percent of members. Pronouns and honorifics in press coverage identify gender for nearly all the rest. Two members who served before 1900 could not be identified through either method and are assumed to be men.

Gender

Elizabeth Magruder was the Board's first woman. She won a seat in the county's first at-large election, in November 1931, and took it in January 1932, the year the Board grew from three seats to five. She stayed 15 years, through four terms, and in 1938 became the first woman to chair the Board, a post she held for three years running.⁴⁷

The year she took the chair, voters approved staggered terms over the Woman's Democratic Club's objection (Section A.2), and women went on winning seats, but only one at a time: Magruder until 1947, Florence Cannon from 1948 to 1951, Leone Buchholz from 1952 to 1958.

Then the run ended. When Buchholz left in 1958, no woman sat on the Board for 15 years.

Ellen Bozman took a seat in 1974, and two years later Dorothy Grotos joined her, the first time two women had served together. In 1983 Mary Margaret Whipple arrived before Grotos left, and for that one year women held three of the five seats. Whipple and Bozman kept two seats through 1995, and women slipped back to one from 1996 to 2007. In 2008 Mary Hynes joined Barbara Favola, and women have held two seats nearly every year since, with one exception: in 2024 Libby Garvey, Maureen Coffey and Susan Cunningham made a second majority.

47. Arlington County Board, "Historical Members: 1932 – Present," Arlington County, Virginia.

In all the years since 1932, women have held a majority of the Board twice, in 1983 and 2024, and neither lasted more than a year.

Race and Ethnicity

The County's People

Arlington was a majority-Black county through 1880 and half Black in 1890. Between 1870 and 1950 the Black share of its residents fell from 63 percent to 4.8 percent, though the Black population itself grew from 2,010 to 6,517: everything else grew faster. The share then barely moved, to 5.8 percent in 1970, and since 1980 the county has diversified mostly through Hispanic and Asian American and Pacific Islander growth.

The county figures end where neighborhoods begin. A county count that rises can hide a neighborhood cleared while in-migration elsewhere keeps the total climbing. Bestebreurtje's dissertation on African American community development in Arlington tells that neighborhood history.⁴⁸

The Board's Members

For the Board's first 14 years Black members held one or two of its three seats, though never in proportion: from 1871 to 1892 they held, year by year, about 30 percent of the Board's seats in a county whose Black share averaged about 55 percent. Walter G. Willson, who won the Washington district seat in 1889 and 1891 and died in office in June 1892, was the last. No source names another member of color until William T. Newman, Jr. in 1988, 96 years later. Since then no more than one has sat at a time except in the second half of 2023, when Dorsey and Talento overlapped, and none sat in 2024. Figure 6 counts every member not identified as a member of color as White, an assumption the Data Appendix explains.

The break came in two steps, and the sources explain neither. In 1888 the county court issued a rule against Tibbett Allen, the Board's only Black member, over his residence; he resigned, and the judge appointed Frank Hume to Jefferson district.⁴⁹ Hume then won the district in 1889, 1891 and 1893, with no opponent recorded in 1889 or 1893.⁵⁰ Jefferson, 65 percent Black in 1880, had elected a Black member at 10 of its 11 elections through 1887, and Allen's removal ended that. Willson held a seat in Washington district until he died, and nothing consulted says why no Black candidate won a seat after him.

Four Forces

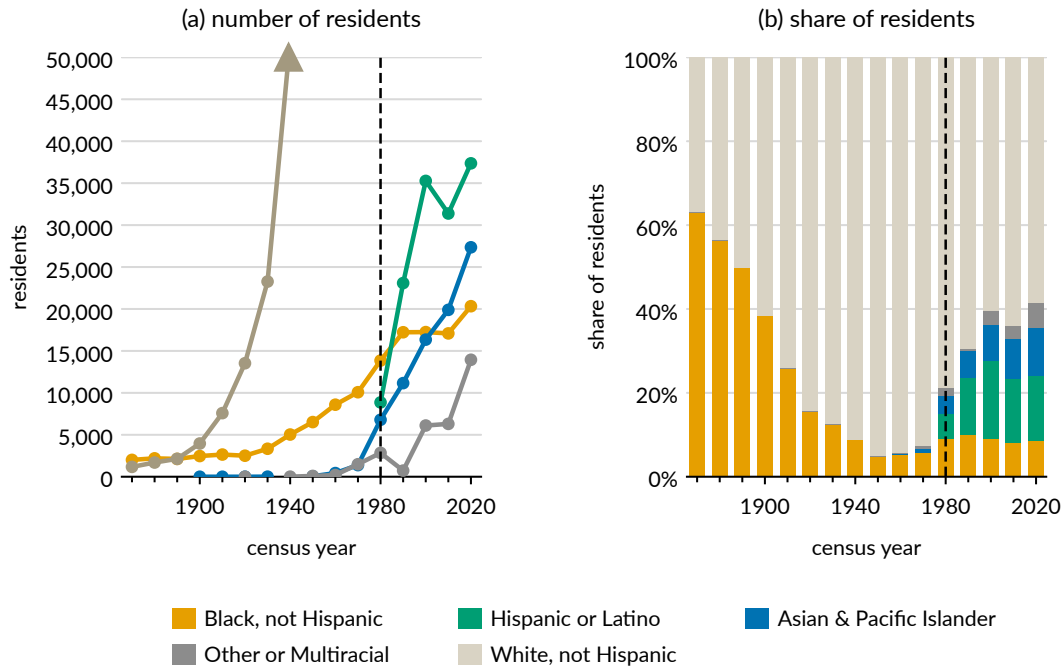
Four forces may have kept the Board white once Willson was gone. The county's Black population fell, from a majority in 1870 to one resident in eight by 1930. The three magisterial districts never guaranteed a Black seat, even where Black residents were the majority. The electorate shrank after the Walton Act of 1894 and the constitution of 1902, taking an unknown number of Black voters with it. And in 1932 the county moved to at-large election, which removed the district through which a concentrated minority could elect a member.

48. Bestebreurtje, "Built by the People Themselves: African American Community Development in Arlington, Virginia, from the Civil War through Civil Rights."

49. "County Court," *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), September 3, 1888, 3.

50. "County Officers," *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 25, 1889, 3; "County Election Returns," *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 26, 1893, 3.

FIGURE 5
County Population by Race and Ethnicity



Notes: Panel (a) gives counts and panel (b) shares. Hispanic origin was first asked of every household in 1980, where the dashed rule falls; before then Hispanic residents were counted as Black or White, mostly White. White counts above 50,000 run off the top of panel (a); they peak at 161,329 in 1970. Source: US decennial census, 1870–2020.

FIGURE 6
Board Members by Race and Ethnicity

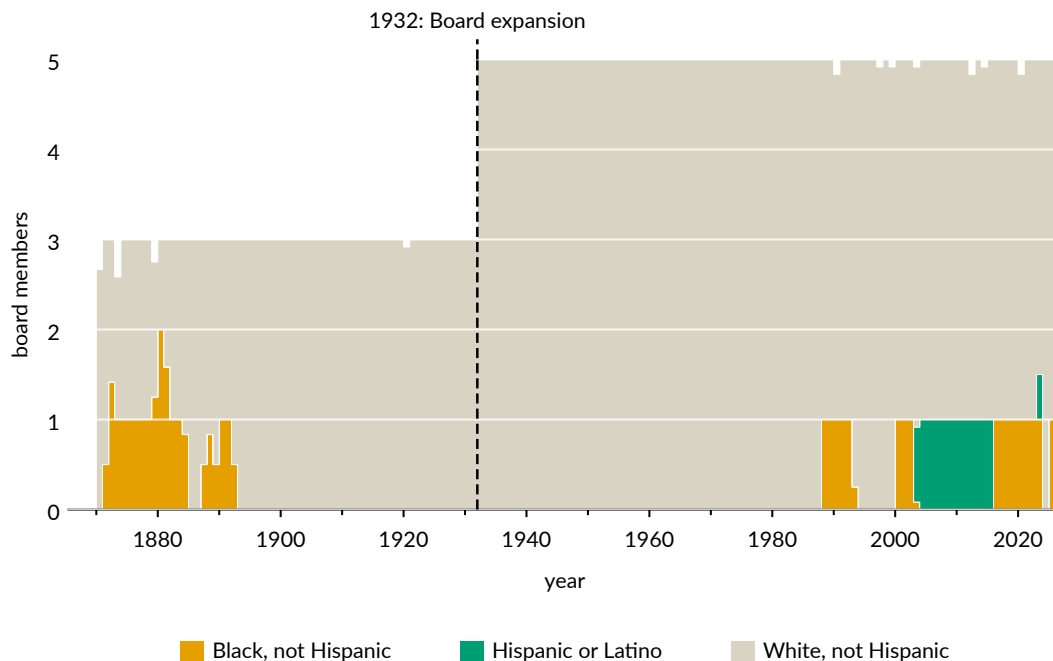
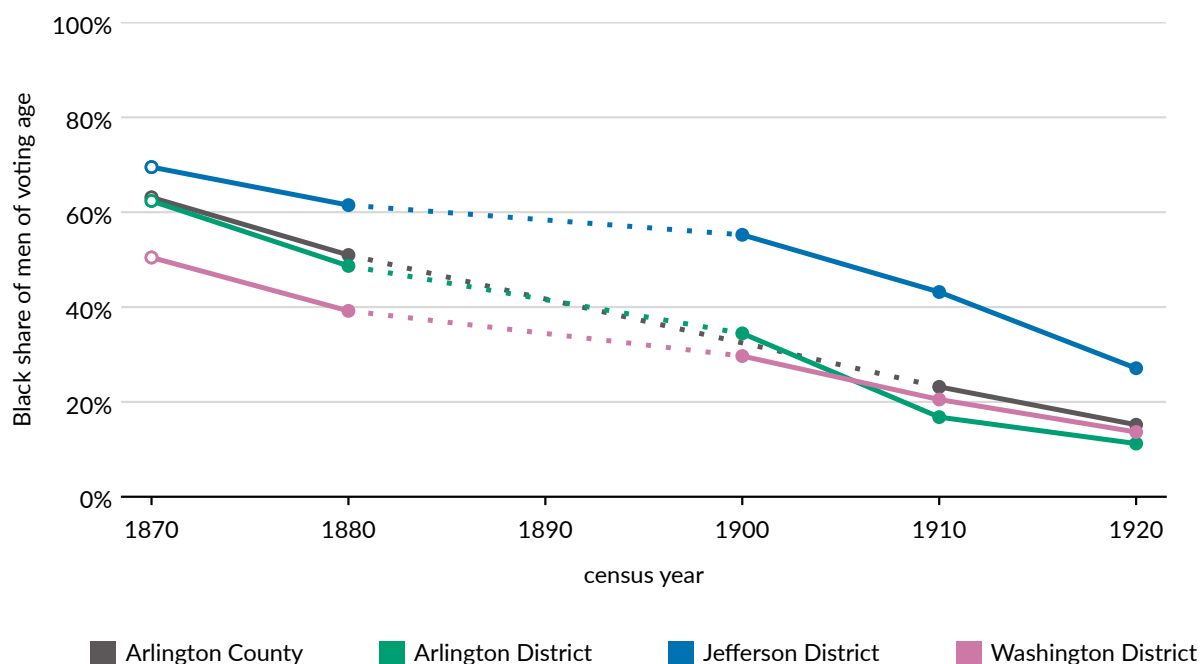


FIGURE 7
Black Share of Men of Voting Age by Magisterial District



Notes: Each line divides a district's Black men aged 21 and over by all of its men aged 21 and over. A dotted segment crosses a census that gives no district count: the 1890 schedules burned, and Arlington district's 1900 schedules are short by about one resident in six. The open rings at 1870 are the Black share of all residents of each township, of every age and sex, not of men aged 21 and over, so each line's first segment joins two different counts: the 1870 volume prints race by township for residents only, and the census file places no one in a township. The county line is the three districts added together, and Alexandria's annexations of 1915 and 1930 mean no district covers the same land throughout. Districts ended in 1932, and the 1930 census has no district split by race. Source: US decennial census, 1870–1920.

A Smaller Black Population

Population change was the background, not the break. The county's Black share fell from 63 percent in 1870 to 12.5 percent in 1930, but 55 percent of the men of voting age in Jefferson district were Black in 1900 (Figure 7), and in the eight Jefferson contests from 1889 through 1903 no Black candidate won. A district that was still majority Black sent no Black member to the Board.

Districts Without a Guarantee

Nor did districts ever guarantee a seat. Jefferson elected a Black member at 10 of its 11 elections through 1887, but Arlington district, 62 and 56 percent Black in 1870 and 1880, did so at 3 of 12, and Washington, the least Black of the three, at none until Willson. In 1885 William A. Rowe lost Arlington district, as the regular Republican nominee, to a "citizens' candidate."⁵¹ A district gave a concentrated minority a route to a seat, and even a district with a Black majority could go the other way.

51. "Election in the County," *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 29, 1885, 3.

A Shrinking Electorate

The electorate collapsed, and the laws that shrank it fit the years the absence lasted. In 1880 the county cast votes for President equal to 77 percent of its men of voting age (Figure 8); by 1892 the figure was 57 percent, in 1900 40 percent, and in 1904 10 percent, where it stayed, at 16 and 16 percent, through 1912. The General Assembly's Walton Act of 1894 made the official ballot the only legal one. It required a voter to strike out the name of every candidate he did not want with a line three-fourths of the name's length, voided any office with more than one name left standing, and let only a constable the electoral board appointed help a voter who could not read the ballot.⁵² The constitution of 1902 required registration and a state poll tax paid six months before the election, and, from 1904, an application written in the applicant's own hand "without aid, suggestion, or memorandum."⁵³ Neither law can explain 1888, which came six and 14 years before them. No source consulted counts how many of the men who stopped voting were Black, but Jefferson district, the county's most heavily Black, shows the fall most steeply. Its 1901 Board contest drew votes equal to 75 percent of the district's men of voting age; its 1907 contest drew 21 percent, and the seat turned on 2 votes of 161. In a district that had sent Black members to the Board at nearly every election a generation earlier, a handful of men voting together could now decide it.

At-Large Election

At-large election in 1932 cannot be tested as a cause of exclusion, because exclusion was complete before it came. By 1931 no Black member had sat for 39 years, and no source names a Black candidate after 1903. The three who ran in November 1931 (Mary B. Harris, E. T. Morton and C. H. Moseley) each finished below sixth place among 51 candidates for five seats, in a county 12.5 percent Black.⁵⁴ What 1932 changed was the route: at-large election removed the district through which a concentrated minority could elect a member. Staggering, which county voters approved in 1938 by 1,539 to 1,487 in the county's tally, then raised the threshold, because most elections filled a single seat and each needed a countywide majority.⁵⁵ No Black candidate ran for the Board from 1932 until 1987, so nothing shows what either change would have done to one.^{56,57}

Attempts to Restore Districts

What moved county voters to choose at-large election in 1930 is known only from testimony. Pratt writes that countywide election substantially reduced Black voting strength compared with a district of segregated neighborhoods, but his account of the motive is the 1974 testimony of George Vollin and Harrison Douglas, recalled more than 40 years after the vote, and he adds that whether the change caused the defeat of 1931 "may never be conclusively known."⁵⁸ The court ruling *Cornelia Rose* reads into the choice is in Section A.2.

52. Act of Mar. 6, 1894, ch. 746, 1893-94 Va. Acts, secs. 3, 11, 15.

53. Va. Const. of 1902, art. II, secs. 18-21.

54. Anderson, "Arlington Adopts the County Manager Form of Government," 67.

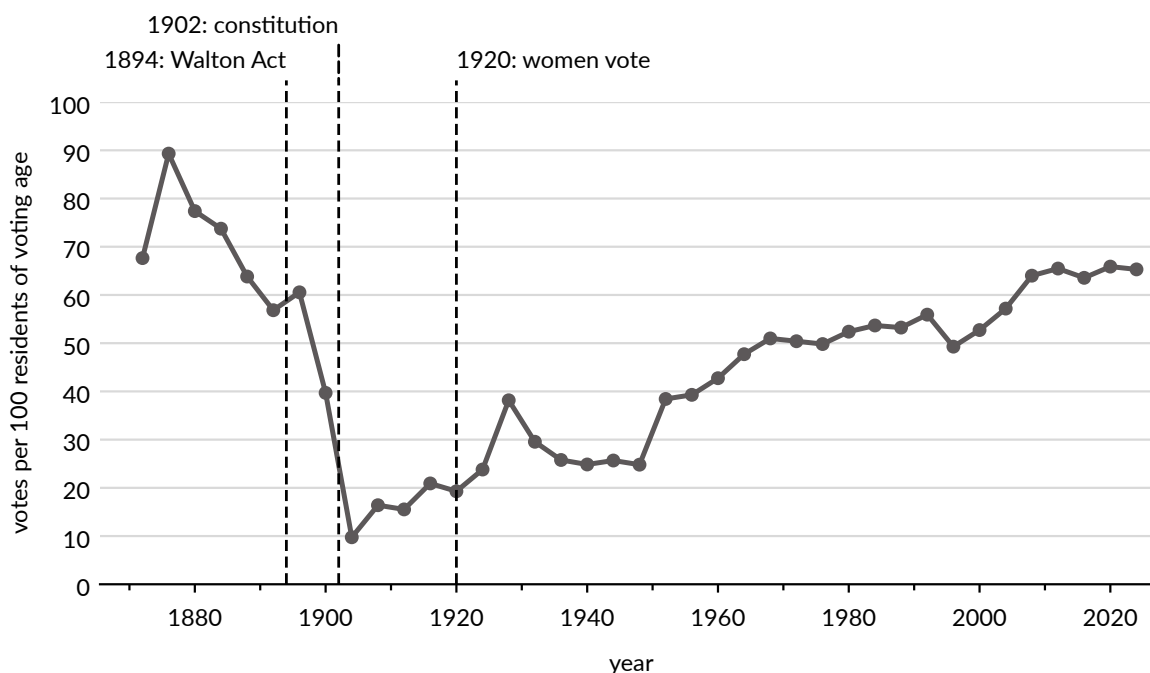
55. Arlington County Office of Voter Registration and Elections, *Arlington County Election Results*, 11.

56. Sherman W. Pratt, "Arlington's At-Large Electoral System: A Study of Its History, Strengths, and Weaknesses," *Arlington Historical Magazine*, October 1995, 22-23.

57. Bestebreurtje, "Built by the People Themselves: African American Community Development in Arlington, Virginia, from the Civil War through Civil Rights," 217-218.

58. Pratt, "Arlington's At-Large Electoral System: A Study of Its History, Strengths, and Weaknesses," 22.

FIGURE 8
Votes Cast for President per 100 Residents of Voting Age, 1872–2024



Notes: Residents of voting age are men aged 21 and over through 1916, all residents 21 and over from 1920, when women first vote, and all residents 18 and over from 1971. Each is the census count, with a straight line between censuses, and includes non-citizens and the people the laws of the day disfranchised. Dashed rules mark the Walton Act of 1894, the constitution of 1902 and the first election with women voting. On the same denominator 1876 reads 76 for Virginia, 77 to 83 for Fairfax, Loudoun and Prince William, and 91 for Alexandria city. Source: Warrock-Richardson Almanack; Secretary of the Commonwealth; Virginia Department of Elections; *Alexandria Gazette*; O’Leary (2010); Arlington County, *Arlington Elections*; US decennial census, 1870–2020.

The two Vollin actions are separate cases. The 1974 federal suit brought the vote-dilution claim, and it failed. The 1976 state case asked whether voters could use the referendum statute a second time to put district election to a vote, and the courts said no.

What the Sources Settle

The sources settle three things. The absence began in 1888, before either disfranchising law and in a district that was still a Black majority; neither the fall in the county’s Black population nor the district system, taken alone, explains it; and the collapse of the electorate after 1902 is the one force that fits how long it lasted. That is a fit and not a count, because registration and poll-tax records by race, which would show it, are in no source consulted. Nor does any source show whether Black candidates stopped running between 1892 and 1930 or ran and lost, or why Allen was removed.

The Historical Society dates Newman’s election 1987, Monroe’s 1999, Dorsey’s 2015 and Spain’s 2024, and this study lists each as taking the seat a year later. Both are correct: each won in November and took office the following January.

Age

In 2020, 52 percent of residents were under 35 and 24 percent were 25 to 34, the largest single band at every census since 1980, at between 24 and 28 percent. Before 1980 the county's age structure moved: children under 18 were 36 percent of residents in 1910 and 16 percent in 1980, and the 65-and-over band went from 4 percent to 12. From 1980 to 2020 the county grew by more than half, from about 153,000 residents to 239,000, and its age structure barely moved. Any commission that takes up the Board's structure after this report starts from that fact: Arlington is a young county.

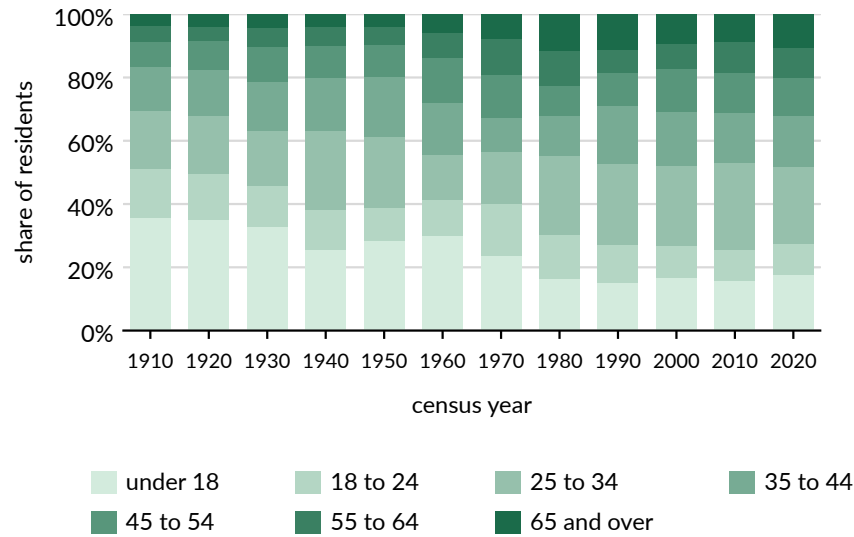
Since 1980 the Board has been middle-aged. Its median age on 1 July has run 4 to 16 years above the county's adult median at every census, 43 to 54 for the Board against about 37 to 39 for the county. Of all the years members served between 1980 and 2020, fewer than one in 25 was served by a member under 35, in a county where adults aged 18 to 34 were 41 to 46 percent of all adults; two in three were served by members aged 35 to 54. Of the 39 members first seated since 1962, four arrived under 35: Milliken in 1981, Ferguson in 1996, Cristol in 2016 and Coffey in 2024. Since 1962 the Board has never had two members under 35 at once. The gap is not a trend, though. It was about 6 years in 1960, and since 1980 it swings with whoever happens to sit.

From 2008 to 2011 the Board sat inside the narrowest age span in the series: five members aged 49 to 56. In 1997 Ellen Bozman, then 72, was the oldest member; after she left, the oldest member's age fell to 53 in 1998 and to 48 in 1999.

Neighborhood

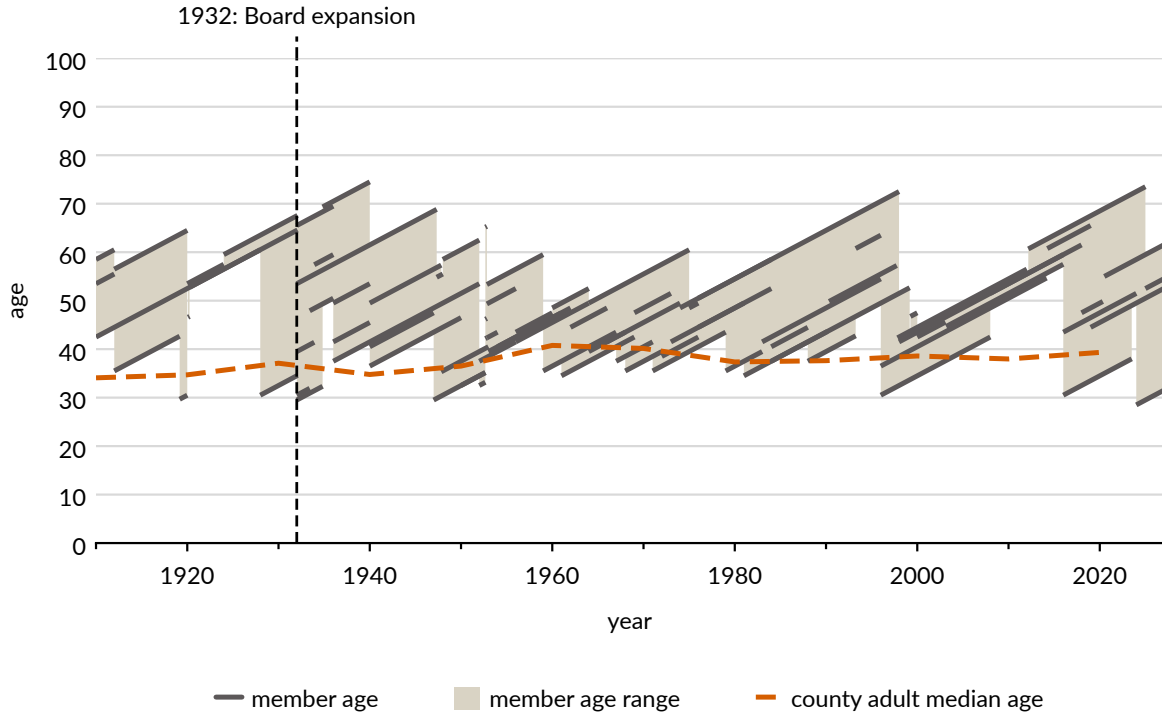
[Neighborhood to come: where the Board's members have lived within the county, once the County's records settle the addresses. Waits on the County.]

FIGURE 9
County Population by Age



Source: US decennial census, 1910–2020.

FIGURE 10
Board Members by Age



Notes: Each diagonal line is one member, from age at first election to age at departure; the band behind runs from the youngest to the oldest member sitting in each year. The dashed line is the county's own median age among adults, 18 and over, at each census, interpolated within census age bands; the open top band, 65 and over, is treated as 65 to 85.

A.4 Local Authority

The sections before this one read the Board's history through the equity resolution, asking who has held its seats and how it divides its work with the Manager. One matter sits outside that lens: what legal authority Virginia leaves Arlington to decide for itself. By agreement with County Board staff, this report treats it briefly. The County Attorney's July 2026 report is the primary resource, and this report adds only the history.⁵⁹

Virginia law, not the Board's own choice, sets what Arlington may decide for itself. The state's courts took that rule from Dillon on Municipal Corporations: a local government holds only the powers its charter grants in words or by necessary implication. *Kirkham v. Russell* (1882) applied it to Petersburg's council, and *City of Winchester v. Redmond* (1896) quoted Dillon outright, which together made Dillon's Rule Virginia law.^{60,61}

Home rule was tried and failed. In the 1968–71 revision of the state constitution, the revision commission proposed letting a charter county or city act on anything state law did not deny it, and the General Assembly struck the provision before the new constitution reached voters.⁶²

The County Attorney's report lists three decisions under the rule, and all three are Arlington's own. In 1977 the Virginia Supreme Court voided the County's agreements with its employees and barred public-sector bargaining statewide, a bar the General Assembly lifted only in 2021.⁶³ In 2000 it held that the County had no authority to extend health benefits to employees' domestic partners.⁶⁴ The 1985 decision is the one that bears on duties. The Board accepted a letter of intent to lease 6.4 acres of the courthouse parking lot to a developer for 75 years and directed its Manager to sign. He refused, and the Board sued to compel him. The Virginia Supreme Court denied the writ because a county has no power to lease, so the Board had never held the power it asked its own Manager to exercise.⁶⁵ Part C's Board Duties section returns to *County Board of Arlington v. Brown*.

59. Ryan Samuel, *Virginia Forms of Local Government* (Office of the County Attorney, Arlington County, Virginia, July 21, 2026).

60. *Kirkham v. Russell*, 76 Va. 956 (1882); *City of Winchester v. Redmond*, 93 Va. 711, 25 S.E. 1001 (1896).

61. Richard Schragger and C. Alex Retzliff, "The Failure of Home Rule Reform in Virginia: Race, Localism, and the Constitution of 1971," *Journal of Law and Politics* 37 (2022): 195–96.

62. Schragger and Retzliff, 200.

63. *Commonwealth of Virginia v. County Board of Arlington County*, 217 Va. 558, 232 S.E.2d 30 (1977).

64. *Arlington County v. White*, 259 Va. 708, 528 S.E.2d 706 (2000).

65. *County Board of Arlington County v. Brown*, 229 Va. 341, 329 S.E.2d 468 (1985).

Part B. Community Input

[Part B is the National Civic League's. What follows is their outline of September 30, 2026, sorted under the report's four headings; every figure in it is theirs and preliminary, and the text is theirs to write.]

The National Civic League read five kinds of public input: public comment at Board meetings, written correspondence to the Board, input summarized in staff reports and Board materials, the County's Resident Satisfaction Survey, and the County's ranked choice voting surveys. Two coders coded 218 comments from about 156 commenters for stance, focus and motivating principle, and the team ran its own cross-tabulations of the satisfaction survey by tenure, homeownership, race, income and gender.

B.1 Demographic Representation

- Public comment is self-selected: residents with the time and the familiarity to take part. Both surveys over-represent White, homeownership and higher-income residents, which limits what they can say about renters and communities of color.
- Who is missing is itself a finding: respondents who decline to give their demographics are the least trusting group in the data, and Latino voters lag on ranked-choice awareness and understanding, so the input may understate both disengagement and distrust.
- Familiarity and trust run opposite: long-tenured homeowners, the residents most familiar with the structure, report the lowest trust; newer residents and renters report more. Commenters are a highly engaged group, so the comment record may over-represent the most skeptical.
- The parallel in Part A: who has held the Board's seats, by the same groups (Section A.3); the one dimension Part A cannot yet match is whether members rented or owned their homes.

B.2 Board Structure

- Most comments support moving forward with a review of the County's structure, and nearly four in five address the review process itself (whether, scope, how) rather than the structure on its merits.
- Supporters and opponents argue on different grounds: supporters on equity, especially racial equity, transparency and accountability; opponents on the process (its purpose, timing, cost, and whether renters are equitably included), not in defense of the current structure.
- Racial equity is the central principle in the comments: 71 percent of comments citing representational equity were supportive. The survey data complicate the picture, because non-White residents are under-represented in the satisfaction survey.
- Housing status is a theme across both sources: comments opposed to reform cite fears of renter under-representation; the satisfaction survey finds renters more satisfied with the current form than owners, on a thin sample.
- Transparency of County decision-making is the one satisfaction item that has not improved since 2022, with 35 percent satisfied in 2026, and comments name recent County decisions

that degraded trust. Residents rate the County's general communication well (64 percent satisfied) and its decision-making poorly.

- NCL's own table maps comment codes to survey items: "structure is right for this community" and accountability and independence; trust in elected officials and in the County Manager; transparency and public engagement; representational equity and the subgroup differences.

B.3 Election Method

- Voters find ranked choice voting easy to use but harder to understand, especially how ballots are counted: 87 percent say they understand the count, and about half could name the winner.
- Renters are more supportive of ranked choice voting than owners, mirroring the renter-owner gap in the satisfaction survey.
- Latino voters lag on awareness, understanding and support, pointing to a voter education need.
- The parallel in Part A: Section A.2, the methods by which the Board's members have been chosen.

B.4 Local Authority

Whether any of the community input bears on what Virginia law lets Arlington decide is not yet known; this section says what the comments hold, or that none does, when Part B is written.

Part C. Future Work

The history and the community input point toward questions the Board may want to take up next. The four overlap: a question about Board structure is also a question about election method, and a change to either runs into the limits of local authority.

C.1 Board Structure

Board Duties

Where the Board's authority ends and the County Manager's begins is a question a future review could take up, and the county has answered it once for itself. Under the plan voters adopted in 1930 the Board appoints the Manager, who holds the county's administrative and executive powers; in November 1952 the voters decided by wide margins that the Manager would appoint the department heads and serve an indefinite term, removable whenever the Board chooses.⁶⁶ The County's rules have since put the division to work: the Manager appoints and removes employees in the competitive service and writes the personnel regulations, while the Board approves the pay and classification plans and appropriates by department.⁶⁷ The same year, the General Assembly barred a Board member from directing or requesting an appointment below the Board, on pain of losing his seat.⁶⁸ Thirty years later it narrowed the bar to dictating an appointment outright, dropped the penalty, and added a sentence letting the Board discuss appointments and removals with the Manager.⁶⁹

The one court test since came in 1985. The Board directed its Manager to sign a 75-year lease of part of the courthouse parking lot, the Manager refused, and the Supreme Court of Virginia denied the writ to compel him because a county then had no power to lease, so the line between Board and Manager stood where the 1952 vote had left it.⁷⁰ Whether the two roles are clear to residents, and whether each answers to them, are questions the evidence in this report cannot settle; how other manager counties and the model charters draw the same line is beyond its scope, and a comparison could be future work if the County wanted one.

Board Seats

The Board has not grown in nearly a century, and the county around it has. Five members have sat since 1932, and each seat has come to stand for about 48,000 residents today, against about 1,000 in 1870 (Figure 1).

Beside Virginia's other cities and counties of 100,000 or more, each Arlington member stands for about as many residents as each member in Loudoun (47,000) and Virginia Beach (42,000), and for far more than each member in the two cities nearest Arlington's size, Norfolk (30,000) and Chesapeake (28,000). Only the larger counties carry more (Figure 11). Across the Southeast, among the

66. Act of Mar. 20, 1930 450; Act of Mar. 6, 1952 226; "City Charter for Arlington Soundly Beaten."

67. Arlington County, *Arlington County, Chapter 6: Civil Service*; Arlington County, *FY 2027 Adopted Budget, County Budget and Appropriations Resolutions*.

68. Act of Apr. 1, 1952 732.

69. Act of Mar. 25, 1982, ch. 108, 1982 Va. Acts 221.

70. *County Board of Arlington County v. Brown*, 229 Va. 341.

80 other cities and counties of 150,000 to 300,000 residents, five carry more residents per member than Arlington's 48,000, all of them counties of five seats or fewer, and every city carries fewer (Figure 12).

Two other arrangements of the five seats are questions a review would take up. How the chair is chosen is one: the members elect one of their own at the first meeting of each year, and since 1990 the vice-chair has succeeded to the chair the next year.⁷¹ Whether terms are staggered is the other, and the voters adopted staggering in 1938 by referendum (Section A.2).

C.2 Election Method

A district gives a group a seat by drawing the group a neighborhood. The Supreme Court asks whether a minority is large and compact enough to make a majority in a single-member district, and where its members are scattered they cannot.⁷² A district therefore treats neighborhood as the one thing voters share that counts. A proportional count draws no lines in advance. Voters rank the candidates, several seats share one ballot, and a candidate wins by reaching a share set by the number of seats, one-sixth of the votes for five;⁷³ a group wins a seat by that share, whatever its members have in common. The ranking lets a vote pass to the voter's next choice when the first has already won or cannot win.⁷⁴

Two questions follow from that difference, the second arising only if the first is answered one way, and a review of the Board's election method would take up both. The first is whether the whole county decides every seat as one majority, or different groups can each elect someone. Arlington has answered it with the county majority since 1931: every seat has gone to every voter, first in a block vote for five seats, then, once terms were staggered, in block votes for two seats every fourth year and single-seat contests in the rest.^{75,76} The second is whether groups that can elect someone are fixed in advance as neighborhoods or allowed to form around whatever voters share. Arlington has tried the first arrangement: from 1870 to 1930 three districts of one member each chose the Board, and the break in Black representation opened under them.^{77,78} The county has counted ranked ballots to fill several seats once, in the 2023 Democratic primary, where Maureen Coffey was nominated on transfers with fewer first choices than Natalie Roy, 5,421 to 5,607, and it has counted them for one seat at a time since 2024.^{79,80,81} Part A (Sections A.2 and A.3) sets out each method's years.

Four further questions come with either answer, and each turns on a question of state law that this report leaves where it finds it.

- Who draws the lines of a district, and by what criteria. The state-law question is what Virginia

71. Arlington County Board, "Historical Members: 1932 – Present"; Scott McCaffrey, "Matt De Ferranti Becomes New Arlington County Board Chair for 2026," ARLnow, January 6, 2026.

72. *Thornburg v. Gingles*, 478 U.S. at 50.

73. MGGG Redistricting Lab, "Analysis of Election Systems for the Portland, OR City Council," July 23, 2021, 6.

74. Act of Apr. 6, 2020.

75. Anderson, "Arlington Adopts the County Manager Form of Government," 67.

76. Arlington Historical Society, "County Officials in Arlington, 1870–1960," 37.

77. Va. Const. of 1869, art. VII, sec. 2.

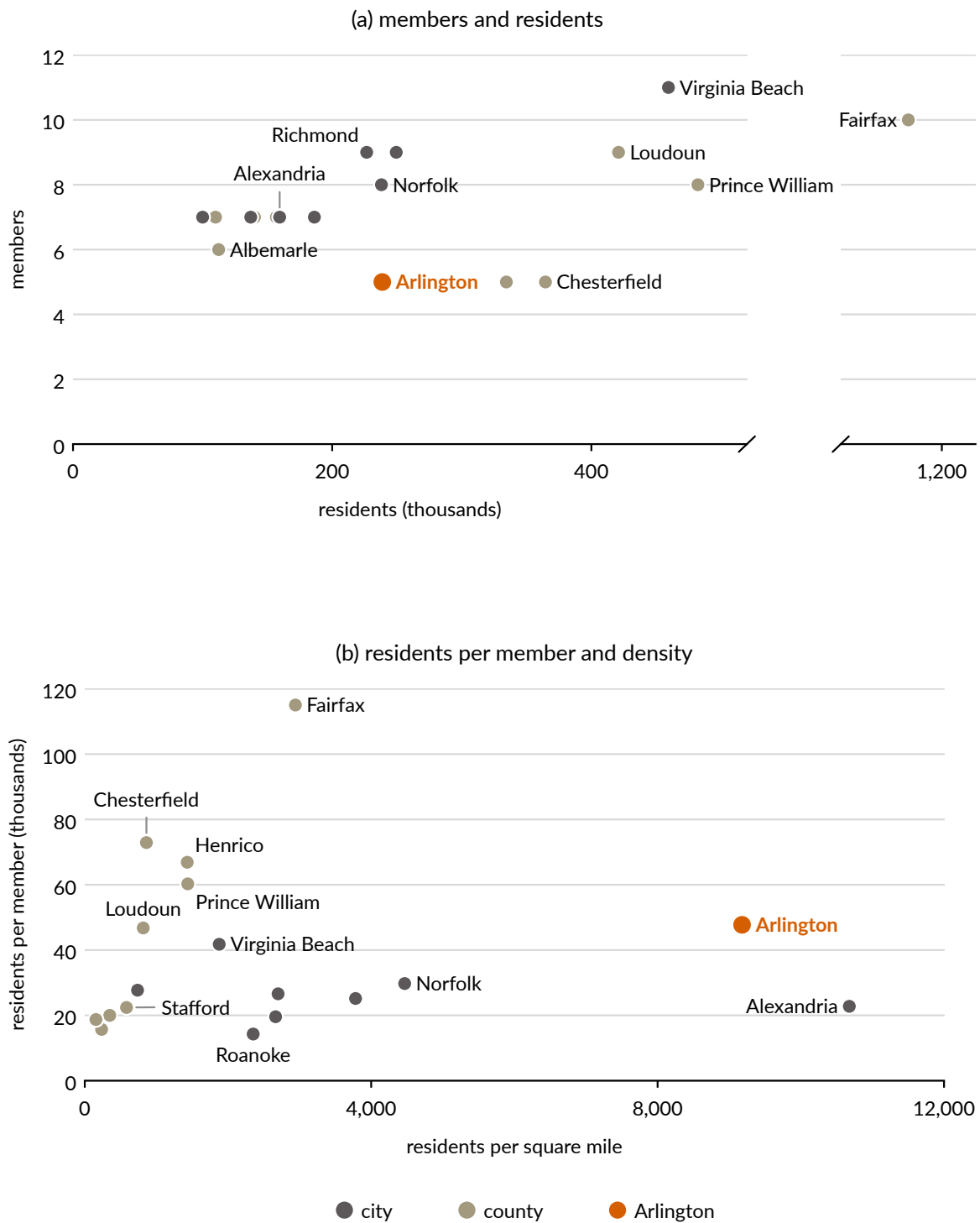
78. Acts of the General Assembly, Session of 1869–70, ch. 76, secs. 4 and 14.

79. Virginia Department of Elections, "Historical Elections Database," contest 160326.

80. "UPDATED: Coffey, Cunningham Win County Board Primary."

81. Arlington County Board Office, *Ranked Choice Voting for Upcoming General Elections*.

FIGURE 11
Arlington Among Virginia's Larger Cities and Counties, 2020



Notes: Virginia cities and counties of 100,000 or more residents in 2020. Fairfax, at 1.15 million, sits beyond the break in panel (a)'s axis. Governing bodies are counted as the Richmond Charter Review Commission counts them. Not every place is named. Source: Richmond Charter Review Commission (2023), Appendix D; US decennial census, 2020; US Census Bureau Gazetteer, 2020.

requires of the lines of a local district.

- What it costs to run for the Board and how campaigns are financed. The state-law question is how far a Virginia locality may regulate or fund campaigns.
- Whether to hold a primary, and how. A change in the general election's method raises it, and with it which electorate decides the seat; the state-law question is the party's right to choose its method of nomination, which the General Assembly gives the party authorities of the county.⁸² This report as drafted does not bear on it.
- The route of adoption: which changes the Board could adopt by ordinance, which would go to the voters, and which would need the General Assembly. The county has used a different door for each method: voters adopted at-large election in 1930 and staggered terms in 1938 by referendum, the courts refused a referendum on districts in 1976 because the statute the county used in 1930 could not be used twice, and the Board adopted ranked choice by ordinance under the General Assembly's 2020 act.^{83,84,85,86} Local Authority (Section A.4) keeps the 1952 and 1976 stories and the general limit.

What the history cannot say is how each method would turn today's voters into seats. Arlington has run each method, but never against the county as it is, and that analysis is research a review would need and does not have. The Data and Democracy Lab at the University of Chicago, directed by Moon Duchin and formerly the MGGG Redistricting Lab at Tufts,⁸⁷ did it for Portland, Oregon in 2021.⁸⁸ The lab took census data on where the city's residents of color live, block by block, and searched for the district maps that would gather them most densely. The most concentrated district in any plan it found held 36 percent, because those residents are spread across the city.⁸⁹ It then simulated elections under each method and counted how many winners the voters of color would have chosen: none under districts, and from one to four under ranked choice for five, seven or nine seats, depending on the number of seats on the ballot.^{90,91}

Arlington is the same kind of case. Each of its groups is a minority of the county: in 2020 Black residents were 9 percent of residents, Hispanic residents 16 percent, and Asian and Pacific Islander residents 11 percent (Figure 5). None lives together densely enough to make a district: a majority of one of five equal districts is about 24,000 residents, which would take 64 percent of all the county's Hispanic residents, 87 percent of its Asian and Pacific Islander residents, and more than all of its Black residents. Districts alone would give none of them a seat, and a method in which several seats share a ballot is the kind that lets a group short of a majority win one. An analysis for Arlington would answer the factual half of the first question: which groups exist in the county's electorate, by race and by whatever else a review thinks a group might form around, where they live, and under

82. Commonwealth of Virginia, "Code of Virginia, section 24.2-509, party nominations: method," Virginia Law, 2026.

83. Rose, *Arlington County, Virginia: A History*, 194–196.

84. Arlington County Office of Voter Registration and Elections, *Arlington County Election Results*, 11.

85. *Vollin v. Arlington County Electoral Board*, 216 Va. 674, 222 S.E.2d 793 (1976).

86. Act of Apr. 6, 2020.

87. Data and Democracy Lab, "About the Data and Democracy Lab," 2026.

88. MGGG Redistricting Lab, "Analysis of Election Systems for the Portland, OR City Council," 1.

89. MGGG Redistricting Lab, 4–5.

90. MGGG Redistricting Lab, 18.

91. The same lab studied Lowell, Massachusetts, whose nine-member council had elected two people of color in 20 years (Data and Democracy Lab, "Election Reform in Lowell, MA," October 21, 2019), and Yakima County, Washington, where the districts of a county commission are cancelled by a countywide general election and the lab compared majority-minority districts with ranked choice (MGGG Redistricting Lab, "Analysis of County Commission Elections in Yakima County, WA," 2020, 1, 6).

which methods a group of that size could elect a member. It would not say which answer the county should want. A fiscal estimate would also be research a review would need, since a change in method or in the number of seats carries one-time and ongoing costs; Portland's budget office estimated both for its charter changes.⁹²

C.3 Public Participation

Who the Board's members have been, by the groups Part A measures, and whether the structure and the election method have anything to do with it.

Gender

Women have held a majority of the Board twice since 1932, in 1983 and 2024, and neither majority lasted more than a year; the Woman's Democratic Club's 1938 objection to staggered terms (Section A.2) is the only source connecting the election method to it.

Race and Ethnicity

No member of color served for 96 years, from 1892 to 1988, and no more than one has sat at a time since; the Race and Ethnicity subsection of Part A weighs the forces behind the absence and finds the shrinking of the electorate after 1902 the one that fits how long it lasted. No Black candidate ran between 1932 and 1986, so whether at-large election would prevent a reversal has no test.

Age

The Board has been middle-aged: its median age has stood 4 to 16 years above the county's adults at every census since 1980.

The commissions, advisory groups, public comment rules, meeting requirements, and records access through which residents reach their government, and where gaps in that access fall, are Part B's subject; this report does not examine them directly. The data appendix comes closest: the years when Board members' homes are hardest to find, 1972 to 1995, are the ones the County's own records should document best.

C.4 Local Authority

The limits of local authority have long been a point of tension for Arlington's residents, and the history records each time they or the Board reached for a change and what they ran into. In 1952 the county's voters were asked to incorporate Arlington as a city under a charter the General Assembly had approved in 1946; a study commission the Board appointed warned that the county would lose about \$750,000 in state and federal road funds, and the voters refused by a wide margin.⁹³ When Virginia revised its constitution in 1968–71, the revision commission proposed letting a charter county or city act on anything state law did not deny it, and the General Assembly struck the

92. Portland Charter Commission, "Progress Report 6," June 2022, 18–20.

93. "City Charter for Arlington Soundly Beaten."

provision before voters saw it.⁹⁴ In 1976 more than 200 Arlington voters petitioned to put district rather than at-large election to a vote, and the courts held that the referendum statute the county had used in 1930 could not be used a second time (Section A.3).⁹⁵

Arlington's own cases met the same limit. In 1977 the Supreme Court of Virginia voided the County's agreements with its employees, a bar on public-sector bargaining the General Assembly lifted only in 2021;⁹⁶ in 1985 it denied the Board a writ to compel its Manager to sign a lease, because a county had no power to lease;⁹⁷ and in 2000 it held that the County could not extend health benefits to its employees' domestic partners.⁹⁸ Section A.4 sets the three decisions out. Which of these limits the County might ask the state to change, and how, is a question of reform options, and those are beyond this report's scope.

94. Schragger and Retzliff, "The Failure of Home Rule Reform in Virginia: Race, Localism, and the Constitution of 1971," 200.

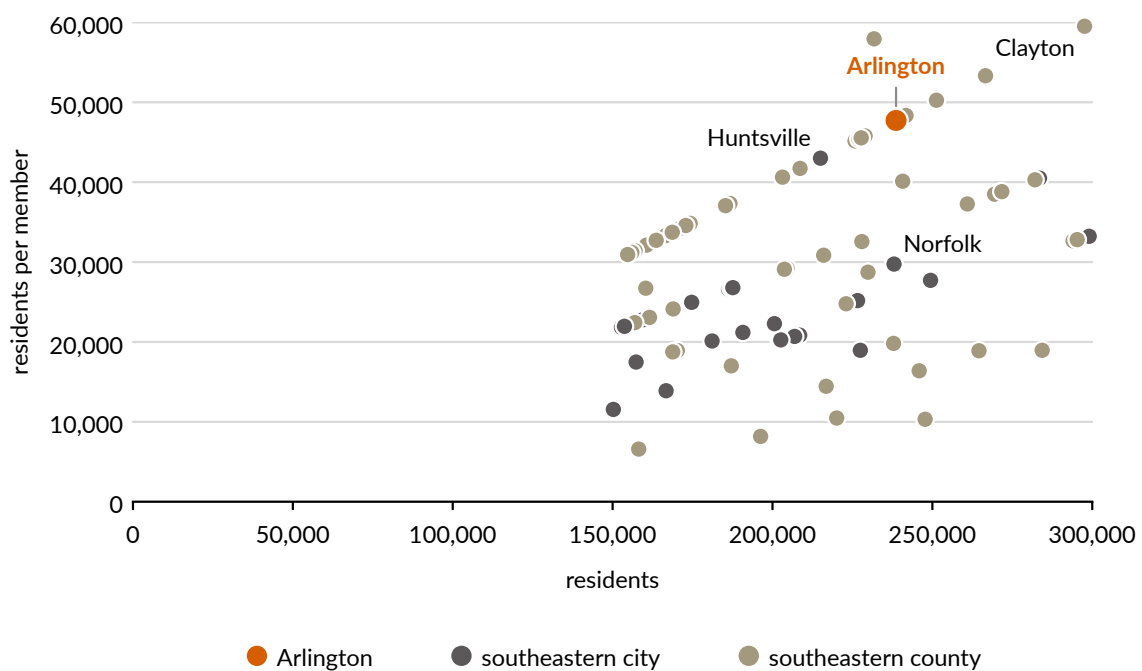
95. *Vollin v. Arlington County Electoral Board*, 216 Va. 674.

96. *Commonwealth of Virginia v. County Board of Arlington County*, 217 Va. 558.

97. *County Board of Arlington County v. Brown*, 229 Va. 341.

98. *Arlington County v. White*, 259 Va. 708.

FIGURE 12
Residents per Member, Arlington Among Cities and Counties of Its Size in the Southeast



Notes: Every incorporated place and county of 150,000 to 300,000 residents in 2020 in Alabama, Arkansas, Georgia, Louisiana, Maryland, Mississippi, North Carolina, South Carolina, Tennessee and Virginia; Maryland has no incorporated place that size and enters by county. Source: Richmond Charter Review Commission (2023), Appendix E; each other body's own page, in docs/localities.md; US decennial census, 2020; US Census Bureau Gazetteer, 2020.

Part D. Data Appendix

D.1 Residents

Population

Population is the decennial census count for the territory the Board governed, which excludes the City of Alexandria throughout. Alexandria annexed 866 acres in 1915 and more in 1930, so part of the movement between the 1910 and 1930 censuses is territory changing hands, not people arriving or leaving.

Race and Ethnicity

From 1980 the groups in Figure 5 are the Census Bureau's race categories crossed with Hispanic origin: Hispanic or Latino of any race, and every other group non-Hispanic. Before 1980 the Bureau did not ask Hispanic origin of every household and Hispanic residents were counted as white, so part of the step at 1980 is the Bureau starting to ask the question, not people arriving. The 1980 Asian and Pacific Islander band also includes the county's 384 American Indian, Eskimo and Aleut residents, because the 1980 table does not separate them among residents of Spanish origin; the band is about five percent too high in that one year. "Other or Multiracial" is American Indian and Alaska Native, some other race, and two or more races.

D.2 Elections

Votes for President

The county's vote for President is the Commonwealth's official return by county wherever one is printed. For 1876 through 1916 that is the *Warrock-Richardson Almanack*, a Richmond annual that prints "The Official Vote of Virginia" from the official returns; from 1924 it is the Secretary of the Commonwealth's own report, and from 1932 the Department of Elections' database.⁹⁹ Two elections have no state return: for 1872 the county electoral board's own certified table, printed in the *Alexandria Gazette*, is used, and for 1920 Frank O'Leary's compilation of the *Gazette*, the only count held.¹⁰⁰ For 1892 and 1900 the *Gazette*'s own district tables, summed, replace the Almanack's county figure, which they contradict; in 1900 the two name different winners. The Almanack is a

99. Warrock-Richardson, *Warrock's Edition of Richardson's Virginia & North Carolina Almanack for the Year of Our Lord, 1868-1891*, Bound volume of the editions of 1868 to 1891 (Richmond: Warrock-Richardson, 1868); Warrock-Richardson, *The Warrock-Richardson Maryland, Virginia, and North Carolina Almanack, Editions of 1892 to 1898*, Bound volume of the editions of 1892 to 1898 (Richmond: Warrock-Richardson, 1892); Warrock-Richardson, *The Warrock-Richardson Maryland, Virginia, and North Carolina Almanack, Editions of 1900 to 1910*, Bound volume of the editions of 1900 to 1910 (Richmond: Warrock-Richardson, 1900); Warrock-Richardson, *The Warrock-Richardson Maryland, Virginia, and North Carolina Almanack, Editions of 1911 to 1920*, Bound volume of the editions of 1911 to 1920 (Richmond: Warrock-Richardson, 1911); Commonwealth of Virginia, Secretary of the Commonwealth, *Report of the Secretary of the Commonwealth to the Governor and General Assembly of Virginia, 1923/25*, Printed p. 508 (Richmond, 1925); Commonwealth of Virginia, Secretary of the Commonwealth, *Report of the Secretary of the Commonwealth to the Governor and General Assembly of Virginia, 1928/29*, Printed p. 453 (Richmond, 1929); Virginia Department of Elections, "Historical Elections Database."

100. "The Election in the City," *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), November 7, 1872, 2; Frank O'Leary, *The Electoral History of That Part of Alexandria County Now Known as Arlington County, 1870-1920* (Office of the Treasurer, Arlington County, Virginia, March 2010).

compilation of the official returns and has not been checked against the Secretary's own canvass for any year. Where the Almanack prints only the leading tickets (1904 to 1916), minor-party votes are missing. The county's candidate history prints the same returns from 1920 and agrees with the state within five percent in every year but 1980, where the state's canvass is kept.¹⁰¹

Votes for County Board

Before 1932 the Board's vote is the *Alexandria Gazette's* returns by magisterial district in the issues after each election, read off the page images, and the figures show it only in the years all three districts' counts survive; each year's issue is cited in the archive delivered to the County. From 1932 it is the Department of Elections' locality rows, with the county's candidate history read as a check. A year with two seats on the ballot records each voter twice, once per contest, so votes per seat stand in for ballots cast in those years.

D.3 Board Members

Sources

Several independent documents name who served on the Board across the years since 1870, and their coverage overlaps rather than running end to end: Figure 13 lays out the years each names, and where two overlap, each confirms the other. The paragraphs below say what each document gives, what it leaves out, and how the roster settles a disagreement between two.

For 1870 through 1931 the roster rests on the Arlington Historical Society's 1967 list of county officials. Its Research and Records Committee compiled the list from the Board's own minute books, and it names each district's member term by term.¹⁰² It dates a term from the first minute that shows a man sitting, but it enters some departures only as "Resigned; date ?" and never states anyone's race. Frank O'Leary's electoral history, assembled from the *Alexandria Gazette* and other newspapers, covers 1870 to 1920 and shows who won each election.¹⁰³ It names a departure only where its prose happens to, gives a surname alone for some members and initials alone before 1912. Where the two disagree about who sat, the roster follows the minute books: an election return names the winner, and the minute books name the man who took the seat. O'Leary gives the Jefferson seat of 1870 to Storm V. Boyd on the election alone, but the minute books say Boyd failed to qualify and never sat, so the seat stands vacant until James C. Roach's appointment that September.

For 1932 through 1994 the roster rests on Norman Novack's list of members, printed in the *Arlington Historical Magazine* in 1994.¹⁰⁴ It records service rather than contests, and it gives some dates to the day and others to the year alone. The County's own roll of members, one entry for every year since 1932, dates arrivals and departures to the day, including the members seated by appointment without an election, and it is the second witness to Novack.¹⁰⁵ The roll has slips of its own, among them duplicated names and a misspelling, so it is read against Novack, and where the two disagree a third document decides. The roll dates Howard Massey's appointment to November 10, 1952;

101. Arlington County Office of Voter Registration and Elections, *Arlington County Election Results*.

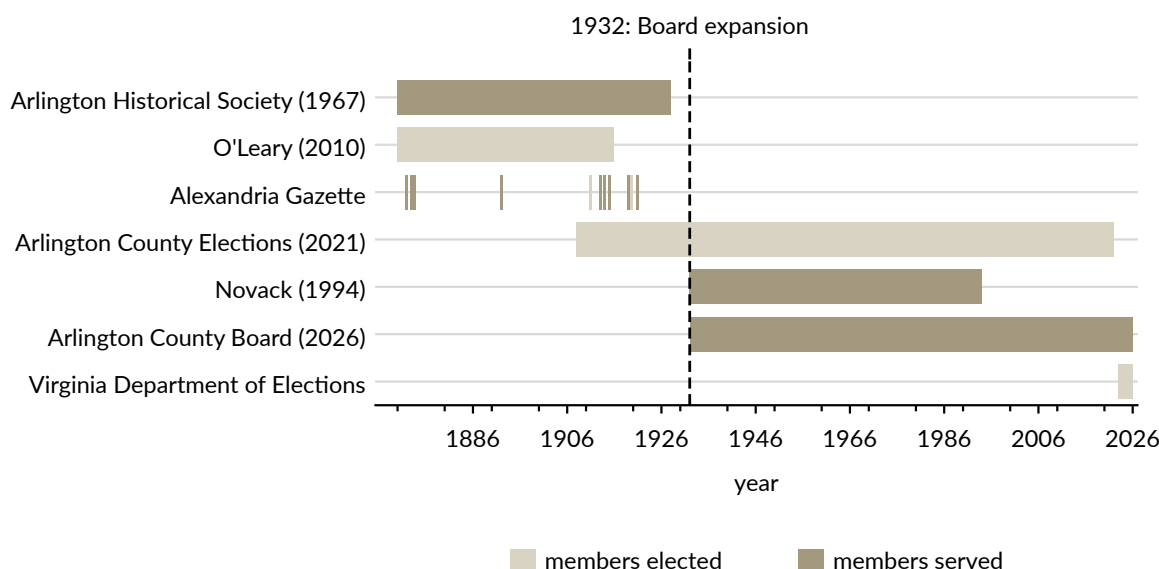
102. Arlington Historical Society, "County Officials in Arlington, 1870–1960."

103. O'Leary, *The Electoral History of That Part of Alexandria County Now Known as Arlington County, 1870–1920*.

104. Norman S. Novack, "Six Decades of Arlington Leadership," *Arlington Historical Magazine*, October 1994, 61–67.

105. Arlington County Board, "Historical Members: 1932 – Present."

FIGURE 13
Board Member Records



Notes: Each bar covers the years a term's source cites that document, so two bars over the same years are two documents confirming each other. The lighter colour marks a document that records members elected and the darker one a document that records members served; the Alexandria Gazette row carries both, since its items are a mix of the two. The Gazette row marks items the roster cites individually rather than as a term's primary source; single citations to the Washington Times, the Daily Sun and ARLnow are not shown. Source: Arlington Historical Society's 1967 compiled list of county officials; Frank O'Leary's electoral history; Norman Novack's roster; Arlington County's roll of members; the County's candidate history; the Virginia Department of Elections database; the Alexandria Gazette.

Novack and the Daily Sun's report of the three members a judge appointed that September date it earlier, and the roster follows them.¹⁰⁶

From 1995 on the roster rests on the County's roll, with the Office of Voter Registration and Elections' candidate history, which runs to 2021, alongside it for the contests.¹⁰⁷ The history lists candidates and results, not the members seated between elections, so the roll is the only document that shows an appointment such as Tannia Talento's on July 15, 2023. The state's election results continue the contests after 2021.

A member's traits come from three kinds of source: the US census, which describes members who served through the 1960s; the press, in news reports and obituaries; and published profiles. A superscript on a value in Table 2 marks its source: the census (c), the press or a published profile (p), or an assumption (a) where no source says otherwise; two superscripts together mean two kinds of source agree, and a dash means no source gives the value. The census closes for 72 years, so the 1950 census is the last open.

106. "Judge Names 3 County Board Appointees: Picks Byrne, Tillema, Massey; Replaces Dugan, Dean and Cox 'Til After Nov. 4 Vote," *Daily Sun* (Arlington, Va.), September 11, 1952, 1.

107. Arlington County Office of Voter Registration and Elections, *Arlington County Election Results*.

Gender

Gender comes from two sources. Census sheets give it for members who served through the 1960s. For nearly every other member the source is the press: the “she” or “Ms.” a contemporary article uses, quoted and cited member by member. Neither source identifies Robinson and Willson, who served before 1900, so both are assumed to be men.

Race and Ethnicity

Census records identify the five Black members of the 1870s and 1880s, and published sources identify the six members of color seated since 1988.

Walter G. Willson is the one member of color identified only by a newspaper: the *Alexandria Gazette* calls him “colored” in its reports of the elections of 1889 and 1891 and of his death in 1892, and no census record identifies him. The *Gazette* prints his name Wilson; the minute books and O’Leary spell it Willson.¹⁰⁸

Figure 6 carries one assumption: every member across 156 years who is not named below as a member of color is recorded as White, because no source says otherwise. For the 96 years between 1892 and 1988 the only evidence is one sentence, the Arlington Historical Society’s statement that William T. Newman, Jr. was the first African American elected to the Board since Reconstruction; no roster by race corroborates it.

For the six members before 1962 whose race no census or direct source gives, a search of the *Alexandria Gazette* and the *Evening Star* by name found no racial label. A missing label is weak evidence that a member was White and no confirmation of it. The *Gazette* printed “colored” after Black names in some reports, among them the Arlington Radicals’ ticket of 1872, the Alexandria city election of 1874 and the supervisors’ elections of 1889 and 1891, but not in its county returns of 1879, which list Travis B. Pinn and Tibbett Allen, both Black on the 1880 census, with no label, on a page whose police report labels two other men.¹⁰⁹ The *Evening Star* of 1957 named a person’s race where race was the story, but no Black candidate ran for the Board between 1958 and 1964, so nothing shows whether the paper would have named Herbert L. Brown, Jr. or Thomas W. Richards as White.¹¹⁰

Figure 14, on page 35, shows where the assumption matters most: most of the members it covers were seated after 1962, when no census sheet is open to read.

Age

Birth years come from census records for members seated before 1960 and from obituaries and published profiles after that. Census birth years are derived from the age recorded when the census

108. “County Officers”; “The County Election,” *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 29, 1891, 3; “County Court,” *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), July 5, 1892, 3.

109. “Arlington Township,” *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 20, 1872, 3; “Municipal Election Returns,” *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 29, 1874, 2; “County Officers”; “The County Election”; “Election Returns,” *Alexandria Gazette* (Alexandria, Va.), May 23, 1879, 3; U.S. Bureau of the Census, *Travis B. Pinn in the 1880 United States Federal Census, Alexandria County, Virginia*, Ancestry.com, 1880 United States Federal Census [database on-line], record 11855799, June 1, 1880; U.S. Bureau of the Census, *Tibbett Allen in the 1880 United States Federal Census, Alexandria County, Virginia*, Ancestry.com, 1880 United States Federal Census [database on-line], record 42596239, June 1, 1880.

110. “Seven Facing Hearing in Racial Seating Case,” *Evening Star* (Washington, D.C.), October 29, 1957, A-26.

was taken, and are therefore accurate to within a year. No source gives a birth year for 6 of 126 members, who are left out of the figure.

Before 1932 the Board has three seats, and four members in that stretch have no birth year in any source, so the age band there covers only the members with a birth year. Medians are of ages on 1 July, and the county's adult median is interpolated within census age bands.

Residence

[Where Board members have lived awaits the County's own records.]

Seat-Years

The stacked figures of the Board by gender, race and party count seats by the year, and a seat whose holder changed during the year is split between the two. In 2023 Katie Cristol left her seat in July and Tannia Talento was appointed to it, so that year's bar carries part of a seat for each, and the edge where one color meets another sits inside the year. That is why the figures' edges are ragged where a member resigned, died or was appointed, and why 1870, whose first Board sat from July 1, is half a year wide.

In 11 years a seat stood empty while a special election was called: 1870, 1873, 1879 and 1920 in the district years, and 1990, 1997, 1999, 2003, 2012, 2014 and 2020 since; those years show a gap.

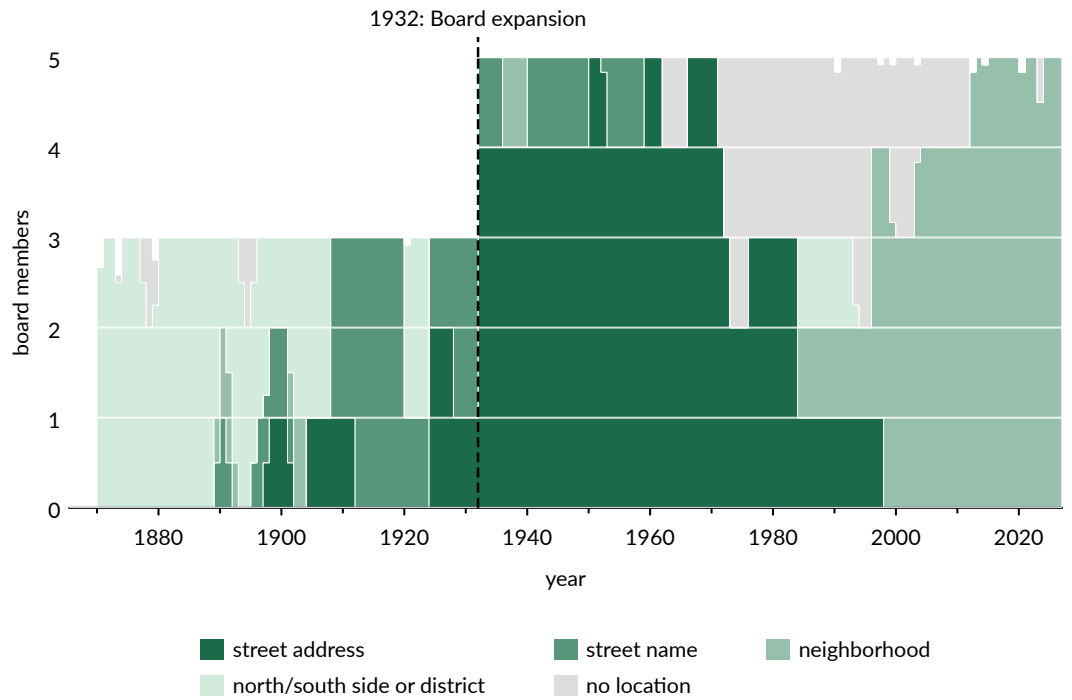
Table 2 lists every person who has served, in the order they first took a seat, with the gender, race and birth year used in the figures. The sources for every cell, one by one, are in the archive delivered to the County.

FIGURE 14
Data Availability: Board Member Race and Residence

(a) race



(b) residence



Notes: Each band is one member. In panel (b) the shade is the most precise place any source gives for the member's home, and grey is none; before 1932 the census names only a magisterial district, and since 2013 the press names only a neighborhood.

TABLE 2A

Board Members, First Seated 1870–1899

<i>Name</i>	<i>Served</i>	<i>Seated By</i>	<i>Born</i>	<i>Gender</i>	<i>Race and Ethnicity</i>
1870s					
H. Dwight Smith	1870–1873	election	—	man ^p	White ^a
Charles W. Payne	1870–1879	election	1822 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
James C. Roach	1870–1871	appointment	1838 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
William A. Rowe	1871–1883	election	1834 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
Edward Deeble	1871–1872	election	1811 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
John B. Syphax	1872	election	1839 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
Henry W. Febrey	1872–1873	election	1828 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Lott W. Crocker	1873	appointment	—	man ^p	White ^a
Francis G. Schutt	1873–1881	appointment	1834 ^c	man ^{c,p}	White ^c
Samuel Titus	1873–1874	appointment	1815 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Gilbert Vandenberg	1874–1877	election	1820 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
William H. Robinson	1877–1879	election	—	man ^a	White ^a
Travis B. Pinn	1879–1881	election	1841 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
1880s					
Christopher Costello	1881–1885	election	1832 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Francis M. Mills	1881–1883	appointment	1811 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Perkins W. Squier	1883–1884	election	1851 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
John W. Pendleton	1883–1884	election	1848 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
Curtis B. Graham, Jr.	1884–1885	appointment	1849 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
George W. Saulisbury	1884–1885	—	1849 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
George W. Veitch	1885–1887	election	1836 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Richard W. Johnston	1885–1887	election	1857 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
John D. Payne	1885–1887	election	1855 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Horatio Ball	1887–1889	election	1827 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Tibbett Allen	1887–1888	election	1840 ^c	man ^c	Black ^{c,p}
A. B. Grunwell	1887–1897	election	1834 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Frank Hume	1888–1895	appointment	1845 ^c	man ^c	White ^{c,p}
Frederick S. Corbett	1889–1912	election	1856 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Walter G. Willson	1889–1892	election	—	man ^a	Black ^p
1890s					
Millard F. Birch	1891–1893	election	1853 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
William N. Febrey	1892–1893	appointment	1851 ^c	man ^{c,p}	White ^c
John W. Clark	1893–1895	election	1843 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
R. Henry Phillips	1893–1895	election	1865 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
William Duncan	1895–1904	election	1854 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
A. D. Torreyson	1897	election	1866 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
George N. Saegmuller	1897–1901	election	1847 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
D. N. Rust	1899–1908	election	1850 ^c	man ^c	White ^c

Notes: Superscripts indicate the source for each record: the US census (c), press or published profile (p), or assumption (a). Two superscripts mean two kinds of source agree. A dash means no source gives the value.

TABLE 2B

Board Members, First Seated 1900–1949

<i>Name</i>	<i>Served</i>	<i>Seated By</i>	<i>Born</i>	<i>Gender</i>	<i>Race and Ethnicity</i>
1900s					
Rezin W. Darbey	1901–1904	election	1850 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Christopher J. Costello	1901–1904	election	1865 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
W.W. Douglas	1904–1908	election	1861 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
W. N. Febrey	1904–1912	election	1851 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Edward Duncan	1908–1932	election	1867 ^p	man ^c	White ^c
1910s					
W. C. Wibirt	1912–1919	election	1855 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Robert L. Walker	1912–1919	election	1876 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Clarence R. Ahalt	1919	appointment	1889 ^c	man ^{c,p}	White ^c
1920s					
Thomas J. DeLashmutt	1920–1923	election	1866 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Frank Upman	1920	appointment	1873 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
W. T. Weaver	1920–1923	appointment	1867 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
W. J. Ingram	1924–1928	election	1867 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
E.C. Turnburke	1924–1932	election	1864 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
B. M. Hedrick	1928–1932	—	1897 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
1930s					
Elizabeth B. Magruder	1932–1947	election	1878 ^c	woman ^{c,p}	White ^c
Fred A. Gosnell, Sr.	1932–1933	election	1892 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Harry A. Fellows	1932–1935	election	1866 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
John C. Gall	1932–1933	election	1901 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Lyman M. Kelley	1932–1934	election	1902 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
B. M. Smith	1933–1935	appointment	1885 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Christopher B. Garnett	1933–1935	appointment	1876 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
W. A. E. McShea	1934–1939	appointment	1865 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
F. Freeland Chew	1936–1951	election	1898 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
George M. Yeatman	1936–1939	election	1886 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
W. P. Ames	1936–1939	election	1894 ^c	man ^{c,p}	White ^c
1940s					
Basil M. DeLashmutt	1940–1949	election	1903 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Edmund D. Campbell	1940–1946	election	1899 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Leo C. Lloyd	1940–1947	election	1890 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Daniel A. Dugan	1947–1952	election	1917 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Harry W. Cuppett	1947	appointment	1892 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Alfred E. Frisbie	1947–1952	appointment	1912 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Florence Cannon	1948–1951	election	1889 ^c	woman ^{c,p}	White ^c

Notes: Superscripts indicate the source for each record: the US census (c), press or published profile (p), or assumption (a). Two superscripts mean two kinds of source agree. A dash means no source gives the value.

TABLE 2C

Board Members, First Seated 1950–1999

<i>Name</i>	<i>Served</i>	<i>Seated By</i>	<i>Born</i>	<i>Gender</i>	<i>Race and Ethnicity</i>
1950s					
Robert W. Cox	1950–1952	election	1917 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Alan L. Dean	1952	election	1919 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Robert A. Peck	1952–1955	election	1914 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Howard R. Massey	1952	appointment	1910 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
John A. Tillema	1952	appointment	1887 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
M. Rex Byrne	1952	appointment	1906 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Alvin F. Kimel	1952–1955	special election	1903 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Leone B. Buchholz	1952–1958	special election	1899 ^c	woman ^{c,p}	White ^c
Robert H. Detwiler	1952–1953	special election	1910 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
George M. Rowzee, Jr.	1953–1956	election	1913 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Wesley W. Cooper	1954–1957	election	1913 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
David L. Krupsaw	1956–1960	election	1912 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Ralph Kaul	1956–1963	election	1914 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Lucas H. Blevins	1957–1960	election	1913 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Herbert L. Brown, Jr.	1958–1961	election	1913 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Leo Urbanske, Jr.	1959–1966	election	1923 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
1960s					
Ernest D. Wilt	1960–1963	appointment	1911 ^c	man ^c	White ^c
Thomas W. Richards	1961–1975	election	1926 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Roye L. Lowry	1962–1965	election	1917 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Harold J. Casto	1964–1967	election	1924 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Joseph L. Fisher	1964–1974	election	1914 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Dr. Kenneth M. Haggerty	1966–1973	election	1924 ^c	man ^c	White ^a
Ned R. Thomas	1967–1970	election	1929 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Jay E. Ricks	1968–1971	election	1932 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
A. Leslie Phillips	1969–1972	election	1921 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
1970s					
Joseph S. Wholey	1971–1978	election	1935 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Everard Munsey	1972–1975	election	1933 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
John Purdy	1973–1980	election	1931 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Ellen Bozman	1974–1997	election	1925 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Dorothy Grotos	1976–1983	election	1931 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Walter Frankland	1976–1983	election	1925 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Stephen Detwiler	1979–1982	election	1943 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
1980s					
John G. Milliken	1981–1990	election	1946 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Mary Margaret Whipple	1983–1995	election	1941 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Albert C. Eisenberg	1984–1999	election	1946 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Michael E. Brunner	1984–1987	election	1943 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
William T. Newman, Jr.	1988–1993	election	1950 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p
1990s					
James B. Hunter III	1990–1997	special election	1940 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Benjamin H. Winslow, Jr.	1993–1995	special election	1932 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Christopher E. Zimmerman	1996–2014	special election	1959 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Paul F. Ferguson	1996–2007	election	1965 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Barbara A. Favola	1997–2011	special election	1955 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
G.N. “Jay” Fisette, Jr.	1998–2017	election	1956 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Michael D. Lane	1999	special election	1952 ^p	man ^p	White ^a

Notes: Superscripts indicate the source for each record: the US census (c), press or published profile (p), or assumption (a). Two superscripts mean two kinds of source agree. A dash means no source gives the value.

TABLE 2D

Board Members, First Seated 2000–2026

<i>Name</i>	<i>Served</i>	<i>Seated By</i>	<i>Born</i>	<i>Gender</i>	<i>Race and Ethnicity</i>
2000s					
Charles P. Monroe	2000–2003	election	1957 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p
J. Walter Tejada	2003–2015	special election	1958 ^p	man ^p	Hispanic ^p
Mary H. Hynes	2008–2015	election	1956 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
2010s					
Libby T. Garvey	2012–2024	special election	1951 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
John E. Vihstadt	2014–2018	special election	1953 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Christian E. Dorsey	2016–2023	election	1972 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p
Kate A. "Katie" Cristol	2016–2023	election	1985 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Erik Gutshall	2018–2020	election	1970 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Matthew D. "Matt" de Ferranti	2019–	election	1974 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
2020s					
Takis P. Karantonis	2020–	special election	1965 ^p	man ^p	White ^a
Tannia Talento	2023	appointment	—	woman ^p	Hispanic ^p
Maureen E. Coffey	2024–	election	1995 ^p	woman ^p	White ^a
Susan R. Cunningham	2024–	election	—	woman ^p	White ^a
Julius D. "JD" Spain, Sr.	2025–	election	1972 ^p	man ^p	Black ^p

Notes: Superscripts indicate the source for each record: the US census (c), press or published profile (p), or assumption (a). Two superscripts mean two kinds of source agree. A dash means no source gives the value.

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